PROJECT BRIEF

Personal Website & Booking Platform

A single-owner website that combines a portfolio, an appointment-booking engine, digital-product sales, and a blog — built for one individual to run their entire online presence from one place.

Prepared for	**A developer (build-ready technical brief)**
Deliverable	**Production-ready web application, self-hostable**
Est. timeline	**10–14 weeks, one full-stack dev (MVP: 6–8 weeks)**
Version	**Draft 1.0**

This brief describes scope, architecture, feature requirements, milestones, and acceptance criteria. It assumes a single owner/admin plus public visitors — there is no multi-tenant / marketplace layer.

01

Overview & Goal

Build a personal website for a single individual (a creator, coach, consultant, freelancer, or professional) that serves as their complete online home. Unlike a multi-vendor marketplace, this is **single-owner**: one person controls all content, services, and settings through an admin area, while the public sees a polished branded site.

The site must do four things well:

- **Showcase** — a portfolio / personal-brand homepage with bio, services, gallery, and testimonials.
- **Book** — visitors self-schedule appointments against the owner's real availability.
- **Sell** — the owner offers paid sessions and downloadable digital products, with online checkout.
- **Publish** — a blog / updates section with an optional newsletter signup.

Payments are required for paid bookings and product sales, but the system must also support **free** bookings and contact-only inquiries without forcing a gateway.

02

Users & Roles

Role	Who	Can do
Owner / Admin	The one individual who owns the site	Full control: edit profile & content, define services, set availability & pricing, manage bookings, upload products, write blog posts, view earnings, configure settings.
Visitor (Guest)	Anyone on the public internet	Browse the site, read the blog, book an appointment (verified by email OTP — no account required), buy a product, subscribe to the newsletter.
Returning client (opt.)	A visitor who has booked before	Optional lightweight login to view their own past & upcoming bookings and downloads.

03

Feature Scope

A. Public site & portfolio

- Branded homepage: hero, bio/about, list of services with prices, image/work gallery, testimonials, contact/inquiry form.
- Owner-controlled theme colour that drives the accent across the site (auto contrast for text).
- Responsive (mobile-first), SEO-friendly (meta tags, Open Graph, sitemap), fast first load.
- Clean URLs, e.g. homepage, /services, /book/<service>, /shop, /blog, /blog/<slug>.

B. Appointment booking engine

- Owner defines **services** (name, description, duration, price, online/in-person, buffer time).
- Owner sets **availability**: weekly schedule, blocked dates, timezone, per-booking buffer.
- Visitor flow: pick service → pick date/time (booked slots excluded, grace-period aware) → enter details → verify via email OTP → pay (if paid) → confirmation.

- Double-booking prevention enforced server-side.
- Automatic confirmation + reminder emails (e.g. 24h and 1h before) to owner and guest.
- Reschedule & cancel flows with email notifications.
- Optional Google Calendar / Meet link generation for online bookings.

C. Payments & digital products

- Payment gateway integration (Razorpay or Stripe) for paid bookings and product sales.
- **Server-side signature verification** — the gateway is the source of truth; never trust client-side price.
- Price is **snapshotted** onto the order at purchase time and never recalculated.
- Digital products: upload a file, set a price, buyer pays → secure, expiring download link + email receipt.
- Free-booking / contact-only mode that skips the gateway entirely.
- Basic earnings view for the owner (paid bookings + product sales, with fees).

D. Blog / content

- Owner writes, edits, publishes, and unpublishes posts (rich text + cover image).
- Public blog index and individual post pages, SEO-optimised.
- Optional newsletter signup capturing consented email addresses for later broadcast.

E. Admin area

- Secure single-owner login (isolated from any guest login).
- Dashboards: upcoming bookings, services, availability, products, blog posts, earnings, settings.
- Content editing for every public section without touching code.

04

Suggested Architecture & Stack

The stack below mirrors a proven booking-platform architecture and is chosen so a single developer can move quickly while keeping the option to self-host. Substitutions are fine if the developer is more fluent elsewhere — the requirements, not the tools, are fixed.

Layer	Recommended	Notes
Frontend	React + Vite, Tailwind CSS, React Router	SPA; single design-token system for theming.
Backend	Node.js + Express (or Next.js API routes)	REST API; all pricing & auth logic server-side.
Database	PostgreSQL	Self-host, or managed (Supabase / Neon / RDS).
Auth	Owner: email+password / OAuth; Guest: email OTP	Keep owner and guest auth separate.
Payments	Razorpay or Stripe	Cannot be self-hosted; verify server-side.
File storage	S3-compatible (S3 / MinIO / Cloudinary)	Product files + images; signed URLs.
Email	SMTP (Postfix) or Resend / SES	OTP, confirmations, reminders, receipts.
Calendar (opt.)	Google Calendar API	Meet links on online bookings.

Hosting	Single VPS + Docker Compose + reverse proxy	Fully self-hostable; add DB backups.

05

Milestones & Timeline

Estimate assumes **one experienced full-stack developer** working full-time. A leaner MVP (phases 1–3) is shippable in **6–8 weeks**; the full scope lands around **10–14 weeks**.

Phase	Deliverable	Est.
0 — Setup	Repo, DB schema, auth scaffolding, CI, deploy pipeline, design tokens.	**1 wk**
1 — Public site	Homepage, portfolio, services list, gallery, testimonials, contact form, theming, SEO.	**1.5–2 wk**
2 — Booking core	Services + availability admin, slot engine, OTP verification, booking creation, double-booking guard, confirmation emails.	**2–3 wk**
3 — Payments	Gateway integration, server-side verification, price snapshot, paid bookings, receipts, earnings view.	**1.5–2 wk**
4 — Products	Digital-product upload, checkout, secure download links, buyer receipts.	**1–1.5 wk**
5 — Blog	Post editor, publish flow, public blog, newsletter capture.	**1 wk**
6 — Reminders & calendar	Reminder scheduler, reschedule/cancel flows, Google Calendar/Meet.	**1 wk**
7 — Harden & ship	Security pass, rate limiting, tests, backups, docs, production deploy.	**1–1.5 wk**

06

Acceptance Criteria

- A visitor can book a **free** appointment end-to-end and both parties receive email confirmation.
- A visitor can book a **paid** appointment; payment is verified server-side and the booking only confirms on verified payment.
- Two visitors cannot book the same slot; the server rejects the second attempt.
- The owner can add/edit services, set availability, and see all upcoming bookings from the admin area.
- A visitor can buy a digital product and receive a working, time-limited download link.
- The owner can publish a blog post that appears publicly with correct SEO tags.
- Prices shown at checkout always match the server-computed price; the client cannot alter the charged amount.
- Reminder emails fire before appointments; reschedule and cancel both notify the other party.
- The whole system runs from a documented deploy (single command / Docker Compose) with database backups configured.

07

Out of Scope & Open Questions

Out of scope (v1):

- Multi-vendor / marketplace features — this is single-owner only.
- Native mobile apps (the site is responsive web).
- Complex subscription / recurring billing (one-off payments only unless requested).
- WhatsApp / SMS notifications (email only in v1; can be added later).

To confirm with the owner before build:

- Preferred payment gateway and currency/region (affects gateway choice and compliance).
- Whether returning-client login is needed in v1 or deferred.
- Branding assets: logo, colour, fonts, copy, and imagery availability.
- Self-host vs managed database preference (affects setup and ongoing cost).

End of brief — Draft 1.0. Timelines are estimates for a single full-time developer and will shift with branding readiness, payment-region requirements, and review cycles.